The Modi world view is underpinned by the intrinsic link between economic growth and projection of power abroad. Modi does not seek standing for India solely through speeches in international forums though he is not averse to that variety of international attention. For example, Modi championed the International Yoga day at the United Nations, taking pride in yoga's Indian origins and universal popularity. During his visit to the Central Asian countries in July 2015, Modi spoke of the ancient relationship based on India's Islamic heritage 'defined by the highest ideals of Islam – knowledge, piety, compassion and welfare'. Emphasizing the links of religion and culture, Buddhism and Sufi music, yoga and the Hindi language used by Bollywood, Modi pointed out that India and Central Asia 'have a special place in our hearts for each other. But, we have not paid as much attention to each other as we should. This will change.'

Modi's foreign policy has also honed in on the Indian diaspora. During the freedom struggle, the Indian National Congress sought the assistance of its diaspora and yet, after Independence, the Indian policy was that an Indian living abroad, while culturally and civilizationally Indian, was now the responsibility of their new country, not of India. During the 1960s Burma expelled Indians and Sri Lanka forced Tamils to leave. During the 1970s Indians living in Uganda for years were forced to leave. The Indian reaction was to preserve bilateral relations with the country in question instead of standing up for their citizens of Indian origin.

In the last two decades, however, Indian governments have devoted attention to the demands and problems faced by the Indian diaspora, recognizing their potential as instruments of global influence. A Union-level ministry was set up in the first decade of this century to take care of the needs of the overseas Indians or Pravasi Bharatiya. There is an annual Pravasi Bharatiya Divas (Overseas Indian Day) and successive Indian governments have wooed their diaspora with awards and incentives. For decades, Indian labour abroad did not find anything more than moral